

There is no such thing as critical thinking



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I was a smart kid my whole life. Teachers told me. Parents told me. They put me in gifted programs and I tested off the charts in anything I did. So when I was a brand new sailor and my boss told me to get off the CCMS console and go to the heads for cleaning stations, I gave him a speech about how I was able to efficiently create circuits for our task group exercise (TGEX) and save him time. He said,

“I’m sure you’re much smarter than me, ordinary seaman. But I’m your boss, and you’re an OD, and it’s cleaning stations, so go scrub the fucking toilets”

Hurt my feelings, but was the best lesson I ever got from the military. No one cares if you’re smart, and if you were that smart, you wouldn’t

have to scrub toilets or face a court martial.

The kind of person who believes in it gets very mad when you point this out, which is what people do when they are confident in something; argue about it incessantly and call you a bitch for doubting the SCIENCE! Critical thinking has nothing to do with intelligence, it was invented by communists for reasons beyond the scope of this essay, and the only thing that matters is domain knowledge.

People, and by people I mean the downwardly mobile, over educated, over socialized, and under employed, love to mix the two together. Telling someone they are intelligent is a great way to soothe their piss poor net worth and shitty future economic prospects. They think being smart is good. They think being critical is good. Critical thinking sounds good, because who doesn't like to be critical and think?

It's all bullshit.

IQ, and I'm simplifying here, is a proxy measurement of how well people can learn new information. Language, logic, space etc. They get the two mixed up because being told you're good at critical thinking means you're good at being intelligent.

Sure, IBM isn't knocking at their door. Sure, MENSA isn't taking any new members right now. Not that they'd know. These people haven't applied at IBM, someone online told them that H1B Indians took all the jobs anyways, so why bother? A critically thinking man would know that. MENSA applications require an IQ test, or military aptitude test. I know this because I did a FOIA request and got my aptitude test results. Well within MENSA standards.

Of course when the clerk handed me the paperwork, and I told her what it was for, she asked: Whats MENSA? And I lost interest in MENSA after that. Who wants to join a club that don't get no pussy?

It's easier to know about these things, never make any effort at them, and hold onto the idea that one is SMART. Neither I, nor the clerk, had heard of critical thinking before that. Of course we critically thought about work performance a lot, the military works that way. If you screw up something goes critical.

But the Harry Potter millennial would rather bitch about the housing market, while making no effort to save up for a down payment, because boomers ruined the property market. Why not save up, in case the market crashes? Nothing ever happens, bro. Oh right, you heard that from a podcaster who was using critical thinking skills.

The beauty about knowing everything and doing fuck all about it is that you never have to put a dent in that Critically Thinking Intelligence. If you try and fail, that's on you. But if you never try, then you never have to look at yourself in the mirror and say that you're not as smart as you thought you were.

Critical Thinking was some commie blather, drummed up by some egg head that swore that the old way of doing things sucked. That you could learn a meta skill, outside of being an expert in any one thing, by learning what he called critical thinking. Don't know anything about writing? That's okay, you can apply critical thinking skills and figure it out from first principles.

Which is why every under 40 person you know is an expert in everything except for the things you have actual domain knowledge of. Gell-Mann amnesia has become the standard, along with Dunning Kruger. they know nothing but can figure out anything. And since most people don't know about most things, they are drawn to the confident sounding figure. And Critical thinkers do sound confident.

Of course classical educators know it's bullshit. They know that the way you learn something is to learn about it. Read up on all the ideas and concepts in a thing, practice the thing, understand the thing by

immersion. But that's hard, and you may not understand it right away. You can spend a lot of work just to find out your not a good astrophysicist, or just join the podcast circuit and give out pithy nihilisms and make bank.



Communism is great at making the children of great men feel special without having to earn it. If fuck you dad was an ideology.

The only way to know things is to study things. Facts, figures, concepts, implantation etc. Don't let anyone fool you. And the guy who knows things knows what he doesn't know, so he's not as confident as the well unread, so don't let anyone fool you.



You need to Stick Your Head in this Bucket. Right Now.

RIAN STONE • JULY 29, 2025

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Like the idiot in this essay, he sees a bucket on the floor, telling you that he knows what's in the bucket with absolute certainty.

Now, I talk about intersexual dynamics, and the space is full of them. Soccer marms who feel a certain way and know exactly what you need to do to thrive in today's sexual market place. This always involves flowers and money and treating her with reverence and sticking to the words of the bible: not those ones that require her to put out or obey or anything, just the ones that help her out and make her feel good.

She loves the bible, and has nothing but contempt for your backwards interpretation of things, but maybe if you do what she wants, that will work too, while getting her approval to boot. You and I have domain knowledge. You can trust your lyin' eyes. Not because they are smart but because you can replicate what you've read and what you know and what you do.

To me, Critical Thinking sounds a lot more like the rules of rhetoric, but distorted into a false sense of accomplishment. Considering how many of our generation have been shut out of the prosperity of the industrial revolution, it makes sense why the kids love it. It's like offering crack to a crack whore.

But it will only ever be a salve. Nothing can shortcut the process. You have to do, to read up on, to learn. It takes work and it's hard and you learn a lot so that you can learn how much you don't know. Making it digestible and overly confident to the lay person isn't your job, succeeding is.

In the end, your goal is to get laid, keep a woman around long enough to throw a baby into her, marry her, or a combination of all three. Don't let women and overly confident retards detract you from that vision. It sounds crass, but you're a human being, you have evolved for at least 6000 years to do this. It's your whole reason for existence. Well, that and power point presentations to afford Funko Pops or that new pistol

you saw in that video that swears any other pistol won't defend you in a self defense situation.

Man that guy was confident about the difference between 9 and 10mm, wasn't he? Critical Thinking, meet ballistics.

You exist for you. Anyone who wants something from you had better offer you something of similar value in return for what they're asking instead of trying to convince you it's your duty to provide, or threatening you for non-compliance. Every moral system is ultimately just a set of rules someone or some group made up and adopted over time to suit their purposes

— 2020 Frame

While you're reading this, take some time to read some fiction as well. Life is dystopic enough. Why not have fun with it and the adventures of a man, like you, crushed under the feminine imperative and longing for adventure and his balls.

Ghost of Odessa

Softbone



Or for the rest of you who already had it figured out and want some relaxation and entertainment. A cyberpunk techno feminist dystopia, and an everyman in a Ukrainian drone war